

SPARK 2026 — TABLE TENNIS RULEBOOK

IIIT Guwahati • Individual Singles • Knockout Tournament

Purpose: This rulebook defines the playing format, scoring system, knockout procedure, qualification process, and match progression for the SPARK Table Tennis event.

1. TOURNAMENT FORMAT

- The event is an individual singles direct-knockout tournament.
- There are 43 registered players in the tournament.
- There will be no league or round-robin matches. Matches are conducted on a knockout basis.
- The tournament proceeds through group-wise knockout sections, followed by the Round of 16, Quarterfinals, Semifinals and Final.

2. MATCH AND SCORING SYSTEM

- Each match will be played as Best of 3 Sets.
- Each set/game will be played to 11 points.
- The player who wins 2 sets wins the match.
- A set must be won by a margin of 2 points. At 10-10, play continues until one player leads by 2 points.
- Service changes after every 2 points. At 10-10 and thereafter, service changes after every point.
- Players change ends after each set. In the deciding third set, players change ends when either player first reaches 5 points.

3. MATCH PROCEDURE

- Players must report to the designated Table Tennis area before their scheduled match.
- The initial server and starting end will be decided by a coin toss or equivalent random choice.
- Players must maintain fair play and respect opponents, officials and organizers.
- The match official/referee's decision on on-table disputes is final for that match.

4. GROUP KNOCKOUT STRUCTURE

The 43-player field is divided into five knockout sections. Groups A-D contain 8 players each, while Group E contains 5 players.

Group	Players	Qualifiers
A	8	2
B	8	2
C	8	2
D	8	2
E	5	2

5. GROUP A-D KNOCKOUT PROCEDURE

- Each of Groups A, B, C and D contains 8 players.
- The 8 players compete in 4 Quarterfinal matches.
- The 4 Quarterfinal winners advance to the Group Semifinals.
- The 2 Group Semifinal winners qualify for the Round of 16.
- Thus, each of Groups A-D produces 2 Round-of-16 qualifiers.

6. GROUP E KNOCKOUT PROCEDURE

- Group E contains 5 players.
- A preliminary knockout match is conducted first.
- The winner of the preliminary match joins the remaining players in the next knockout stage.
- Two knockout matches then determine the two Group E qualifiers.
- The two Group E winners qualify for the Round of 16.

7. BYES

- To accommodate the tournament structure, byes are assigned to selected players.
- Players receiving a bye proceed to the next applicable stage without playing the preceding match.
- The allocation of byes is determined by the tournament fixture prepared by the SPARK organizers.
- The bye arrangement is intended to maintain a practical and balanced knockout structure for the 43-player field.

8. ROUND OF 16 AND SUBSEQUENT ROUNDS

- The Round of 16 consists of 16 players, comprising players who qualify through the group knockout procedure and players who have been assigned byes according to the fixture.
- The Round of 16 consists of 8 matches.
- The 8 winners advance to the Quarterfinals.
- The Quarterfinals consist of 4 matches; the 4 winners advance to the Semifinals.
- The Semifinals consist of 2 matches; the 2 winners advance to the Final.
- The Final determines the SPARK Table Tennis champion.
- Every match from the Round of 16 through the Final follows the same Best-of-3 Sets, 11-points-per-set format.

9. COMPLETE TOURNAMENT PROCEDURE

Stage	Procedure
Initial Field	43 registered players
Groups A–D	8 players in each group → knockout → 2 qualifiers from each group
Group E	5 players → preliminary knockout + knockout matches → 2 qualifiers
Byes	Assigned to selected players according to the tournament fixture
Round of 16	16 players → 8 matches
Quarterfinals	8 players → 4 matches
Semifinals	4 players → 2 matches
Final	2 players → 1 match → Champion

10. PLAYER CONDUCT & FAIR PLAY

- Players must respect opponents, officials, volunteers, equipment and the venue.
- Abusive behaviour, harassment, intentional damage or repeated misconduct may lead to disciplinary action or removal from the event.
- Players must follow instructions given by match officials and event coordinators.
- Players should report on time. Failure to report within the time announced by organizers may result in a walkover, subject to the organizers' decision.

11. EQUIPMENT & DISPUTES

- Matches will be played on the tables and with the equipment designated by the SPARK organizers.
- Equipment concerns affecting fair play must be reported to the official before or during the match.
- The match official/referee is responsible for enforcing the rules during the match.
- Any tournament matter not covered in this rulebook will be decided by the SPARK organizing committee.

12. WOMEN'S MATCHES

- Women's Table Tennis matches will be conducted separately from the open/men's matches.
- The women's matches will follow the same applicable match and scoring rules unless otherwise specified by the SPARK organizing committee.
- The schedule and fixture for the women's matches will be communicated separately by the organizers.

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Play Fair • Play Hard • Respect the Game